GeoArcade FRQ Tutor · Teacher Guide

AP Human Geography · Panther Creek High School · everything you need to get started

What it is

A step-by-step tutor that walks one student through one FRQ, the way you would sitting next to them. For each part (A–G) the student taps through six short cards: **Ask** (the question in plain words, plus a coach who names what they're probably thinking) → **Verb** (Identify / Describe / Explain decoded) → **Learn** (a mini-lesson and one quick-check question) → **Think** (T1- / E2- / A3- steps with hints) → **Write** (a weak answer to avoid, a sentence frame if they're stuck) → **Check** (rubric checklist, fix-it tips, model answer). Background pop-outs teach the history or concept a kid would otherwise Google. Nothing saves and no login is needed.

What's in each unit

Unit	FRQs	AP exam formats practiced
1 · Thinking Geographically	Two Scales, One State · Mapping the Storm	One stimulus (map) · No stimulus
2 · Population & Migration	Fewer Babies, Bigger Cities · On the Move	One stimulus (table) · Two stimuli (flow map + migrant account)
3 · Culture	English Goes Global (class FRQ) · Maple Street District	One stimulus (table) · One stimulus (text)
4 · Political	Lines on the Map (class FRQ: Colonial Boundaries in Africa) · Who's in Charge Here? (released AP practice) · Drawing the Lines	Two stimuli (the two handout maps) · No stimulus · Two stimuli
5 · Agriculture	Rings of Farmland · Miracle Seeds	One stimulus (diagram) · No stimulus
6 · Cities	Brookhaven Spreads Out · City of Contrasts	One stimulus (table) · Two stimuli (city model + city-size table)
7 · Development	Measuring Up · The Factory Floor · Rails of the Raj	One stimulus (table) · No stimulus · One stimulus (map)

All practice FRQs are original, with fictional places and data where a stimulus needs numbers. The two class FRQs (Units 3 and 4) and Who's in Charge Here? are publicly released questions; Unit 4's class FRQ uses the real maps from the class handout.

Putting it on GeoArcade

1. Open the unit file (for example `units/frq-tutor-unit3.html`) and copy everything.
2. In Google Sites: **Insert → Embed → Embed code**, paste, then **Next → Insert**.
3. Drag the embed box tall: about **900 px** or more. The tutor scrolls inside it.

4. Above the box, add a normal text block such as “AP Human Geography Unit 3 FRQ Tutor: practice free-response step by step.” Google can't read text inside an embed, so this is what makes the page findable.

Ways to use it in class

Bell-ringer (5 min). Project the stimulus screen and do the three “What do you notice?” prompts together before anyone sees a question.

Model one part (10 min). Project one part and think aloud through the Think card. Let the class vote on the weak answer before revealing why it misses.

Homework (20 min). Assign one FRQ. Students finish, tap **Copy my answers** on the results screen, and paste into a Canvas text submission. The paste includes every labeled answer and whether they earned each point.

Reteach. The results screen sorts parts into Nailed it / Review these / Not tried yet, with links to the right pop-outs. Assign just the missed parts with **Retry what I missed**.

Paper day. Print the student handout from `print/`; it has the stimulus, all seven questions, and labeled T1-/E2-/A3- lines. The matching teacher key lists what earns each point, the model answer, and the most common wrong answer.

Spaced review. Before a unit test, have students replay an FRQ from an earlier unit and do the 3-question Boss Round.

Honest limits. The auto-check is a keyword guess, not a grader. It pre-ticks rubric items, and the student makes the final call. Treat a student's self-score as a starting point, and spot-check the pasted answers in Canvas.

Why it's built this way

- **One card at a time:** small, self-paced chunks beat showing everything at once (Mayer's segmenting principle).
- **Quick checks and the Boss Round:** practice testing and spaced practice were the two highest-rated study techniques in Dunlosky et al.'s 2013 review.
- **“How sure are you?”** before checking: metacognition is one of the highest-impact strands in the EEF Teaching and Learning Toolkit.
- **Worked examples, weak-answer examples, and fix-it feedback:** feedback on the task and process, not just “good job.”